

PHASE 1

FLOW CREATION

Milestone: Flow

Activity 1: Create a Flow to create a Catalog Task, update its short description after approval of the Service Request, and assign it to Hardware.

Stated activity duration: 40 minutes

Project: Streamlining IT Procurement — Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Platform: ServiceNow (Flow Designer, Service Catalog)

1. Phase Overview

This phase covers the creation of the core automation logic for the Standard Laptop Procurement Automation project. A ServiceNow Flow Designer flow, named "**Standard laptop task**", was built and activated. The flow listens for Service Catalog activity and automatically generates a Catalog Task whenever a request is processed, pre-filling the task with the correct description, description text, and assignment group so that the Hardware team can begin configuration without any manual task creation.

2. Objective

Create and activate a ServiceNow Flow Designer flow that automatically creates a Catalog Task for a Standard Laptop request and sets the required task details (short description, description, assignment group, and approval status) without manual intervention.

3. Problem Addressed

In the existing manual process, IT staff had to notice an approved laptop request, manually create a Catalog Task, and manually assign it to the Hardware team. This step-by-step dependency on human action introduced delays, inconsistent task details, and occasional missed requests. Automating task creation removes this manual bottleneck and ensures every approved Standard Laptop request is handled identically and promptly.

4. Platform and Components Used

- ServiceNow platform
- Flow Designer (Process Automation)
- Service Catalog (trigger source)
- Catalog Task [sc_task] table (action target)
- Requested Item record (data pill used for mapping)

5. Detailed Step-by-Step Configuration

5.1 Flow Creation and Properties

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Click **All** and search for **Flow Designer**.
3. Open **Flow Designer** under the Process Automation module.
4. Click **New** and select **Flow**.
5. Under Flow properties, enter the flow name as "**Standard laptop task**".
6. Set **Application** to **Global**.
7. Set **Run As** to **System User**.
8. Click **Submit** to create the flow shell.

5.2 Trigger Configuration

1. Click **Add a trigger**.
2. Search for **Service Catalog** and select that trigger type.

3. Click **Done** to confirm the trigger.

5.3 Action Configuration — Create Catalog Task

1. Under Actions, click **Add an action**.
2. Search for and select **Create Catalog Task**.
3. Map the **Requested Item Record** data pill (from the trigger) to the **Requested Item** input field.
4. The **Table Name** field auto-populates as **Catalog Task [sc_task]**.
5. Set **Short Description** to "**Laptop need to Configured**".
6. Click **Add field value** to expose additional field mappings.
7. Set the **Description** field to "**Laptop need to Configured**".
8. Set the **Assignment group** field to "**Hardware**".
9. Set the **Approval** field to "**Approved**".
10. Leave all remaining fields at their defaults and click **Done**.

5.4 Save and Activation

1. Click **Save** to persist the flow.
2. Click **Activate**, then confirm activation in the dialog that follows.

6. Configuration Table — Exact Field Values

Setting / Field	Value
Flow name	Standard laptop task
Application	Global
Run As	System User
Trigger type	Service Catalog
Action	Create Catalog Task
Table Name	Catalog Task [sc_task]
Requested Item (input)	Trigger → Requested Item Record
Short Description	Laptop need to Configured
Description	Laptop need to Configured
Assignment group	Hardware
Approval	Approved
Flow status after save	Active

7. Implementation Evidence

The following screenshots were captured from the author's own ServiceNow instance during implementation of this phase.

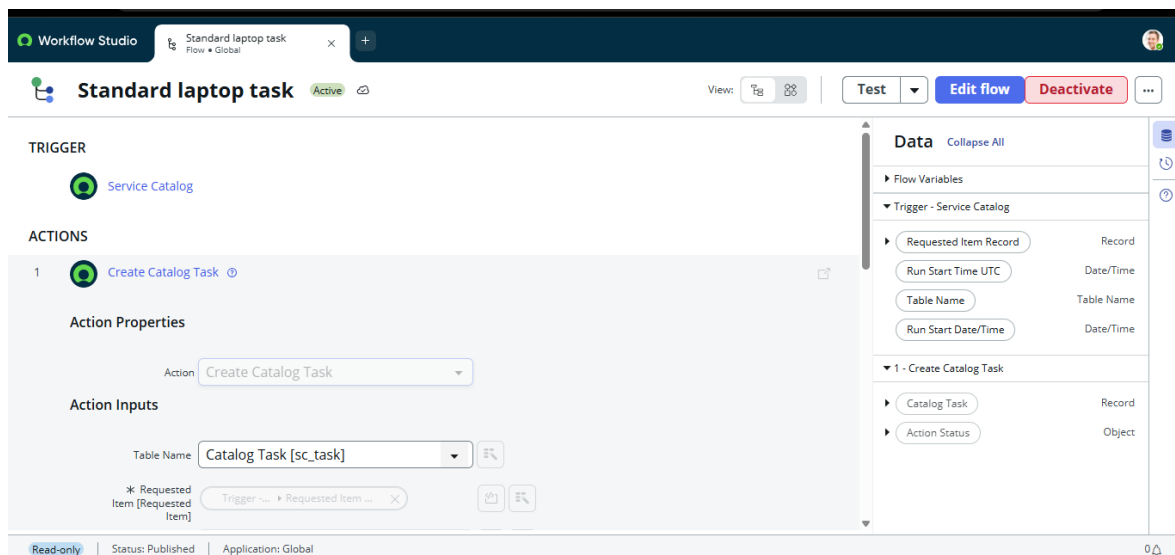


Figure 1.1 — Author's implementation: "Standard laptop task" flow shown Active, with the Service Catalog trigger and the Create Catalog Task action visible in Flow Designer.

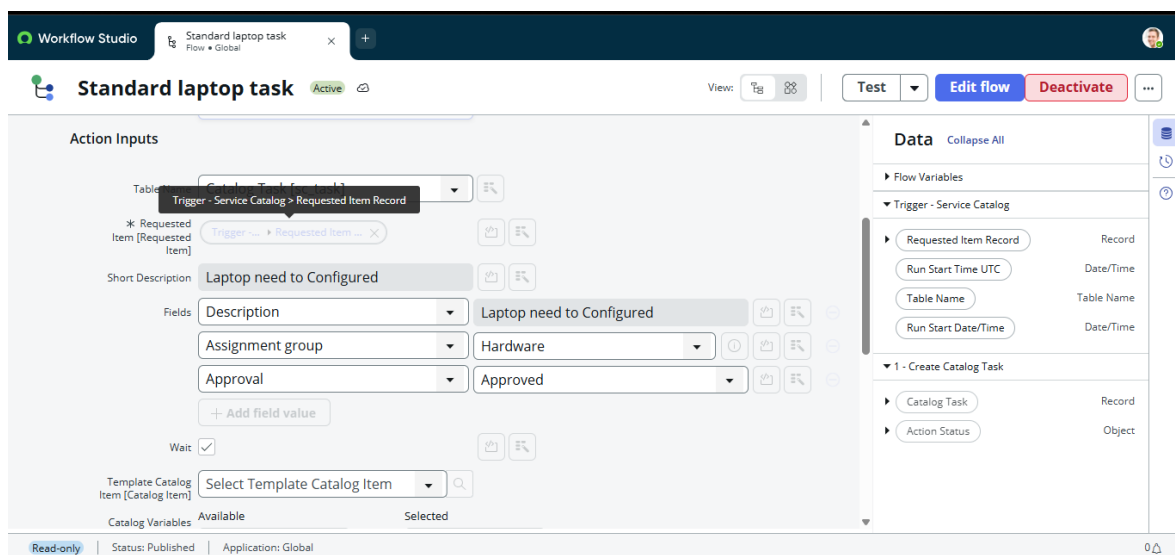


Figure 1.2 — Author's implementation: Create Catalog Task action inputs, showing the Short Description, Description, Assignment group ("Hardware"), and Approval ("Approved") field mappings configured as specified.

8. Expected Outcome

Once activated, the flow runs automatically whenever the Service Catalog trigger condition is met. For every Standard Laptop request that reaches the trigger point, a new Catalog Task record is created under the corresponding Requested Item, with the Short Description and Description set to "Laptop need to Configured", the Assignment group set to "Hardware", and the Approval field set to "Approved" — requiring no manual task creation by IT staff.

9. Acceptance Checklist

- [] Flow named "Standard laptop task" created under the Global application scope.
- [] Run As set to System User.
- [] Service Catalog trigger added and configured.
- [] Create Catalog Task action added with the Table Name auto-populated as Catalog Task [sc_task].

- [] Requested Item Record data pill correctly mapped to the Requested Item input.
- [] Short Description and Description fields set to "Laptop need to Configured".
- [] Assignment group set to Hardware.
- [] Approval field set to Approved.
- [] Flow saved and Activated (status confirmed as Active in Flow Designer).

10. Conclusion

Phase 1 successfully establishes the automation core of the project. By configuring the "Standard laptop task" flow with a Service Catalog trigger and a Create Catalog Task action, the system is now capable of generating correctly populated Catalog Tasks without manual effort. This flow forms the foundation that Phase 2 attaches to the Standard Laptop catalog item, and that Phase 3 validates end-to-end.